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Sony Xperia Z3+

Always runs hot, falls quite short of expectations

When the processor that is the Snapdragon 810 is just one of the issues with your smartphone, you've got problems. The heating issues on the Sony Xperia Z3+ are apparent even when you're just dialing numbers. The best example of this is Sony's camera app, which keeps crashing because the phone is too hot. This becomes even more apparent when you try shooting videos in 4K. On a regular day's usage, the phone starts heating up even when it is kept idle but with somewhat heavy background activity.

The state of the processor also affects the battery life of the smartphone. While Sony claimed that the phone has "best in class" battery life, it really isn't anywhere close to its competitors. If you try hard enough, you may be able to get this phone to last for about 10 hours, but that's about it. If you don't use the power saver modes and prevent gaming completely, the battery on the Sony Xperia Z3+ lasts for at best six hours, which for a flagship, is really bad.

Apart from the performance, the camera is usually one of the main features of Sony's flagships. While the 20.7 MP shooter on the Xperia Z3+ is good, it is still largely the same as it was before. Sony has made some changes in terms of the algorithm behind the camera, but these changes don't amount to much of a visible difference in quality. Heck, there is no visible difference here when you compare it to the likes of the Xperia Z3 or even LG's new flagship – the LG G4 as the camera on the Z3+ fails to even surpass the other two behemoths. The camera is also really slow by today's standards as it takes a longer time than the competition to snap. Of course, none of these really matter since every time you try to use the camera for extended periods, the camera app will crash suddenly when you need it the most leaving you scratchin your head in frustration.

The Xperia Z3+ also looks the same as its predecessor. Don't get us wrong, if you liked Sony's



Price
₹55,990

older flagship designs, you'll most likely love this one too. And the Xperia Z3+ is a good looking and premium device, with its glass back and metal frame, but none of that changes the fact that there is barely any difference in how it looks. The only visible difference in the looks here is that the Xperia Z3 had a slightly flattened frame, while the Xperia Z3+ has a rounded metal frame on its side. Other than that, everything else in the overall design department is ditto like the Xperia Z3.

There's also the new capless USB that Sony had first showcased in the Xperia M4 Aqua smartphone. While the company has to be commended for the achievement, it really makes no difference since there is still a flap for the SD card etc. Yes, there's one less broken flap to deal with potentially, but you still may have

to deal with that.

To give credit where it's due, props to Sony for the beautiful display on the Xperia Z3+. On paper, a FullHD 5.2 inch display sounds nothing against the QHD monsters in the market today, but in a display comparison against its flagship competitors, in the Samsung Galaxy S6, HTC One M9+ and LG G4, we found the Xperia Z3+ to be one of the best. The display shows a wider colour gamut than both the Samsung Galaxy S6 and HTC One M9+, coming up only slightly behind the LG G4 in that respect.

The display alone is not enough to recommend this smartphone though. While the Sony Xperia Z3 was snagged our Zero1 Awards last year, the Xperia Z3+ is arguably the worst out of the flagship smartphones launched this year. Sony now needs to rethink how it plans to go about launching flagships. They have done so well with that respect in the past that they can follow the same idea of releasing an all-rounded product that just works. If you have a Xperia Z3, stick to it, because this is no upgrade. If you absolutely want a flagship phone, you can pick anything but this one.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.2inch 1080p;
Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 810 octa-core 64-bit; **Battery:** 2930 mAh; **Camera:** 20.7MP rear, 5.1MP front; **Storage:** 32GB, expandable to 128GB; **RAM:** 3GB

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